



The Selectboard
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
TOWN HALL
1 SOUTH ROAD
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

Minutes of the Meeting
Wednesday, March 2, 2026, 7:00 PM
at the Town Hall, 1 South Road

CALL TO ORDER

The Selectboard was called to order at 7:02 PM

PRESENT: Susan Bronstein (Chair), Scott Johndrow, Jennifer Milikowsky

ALSO PRESENT: Douglas Finn, Others as noted.

PUBLIC COMMENT on any item not on the agenda

Mr. Andrew Klyman noted a recent letter sent to the Selectboard in regard to the condition of Northwest Road. Mr. Klyman emphatically noted the quality of work conducted by the Westhampton Highway Department; however, he noted that the road condition was somewhat terrible. Mr. Klyman also noted that speed limit signs would be helpful.

Ms. Bronstein noted receipt of Mr. Klyman's letter. The board reviewed a draft of a written letter responding to Mr. Klyman.

After some discussion, the Selectboard agreed that continuing the conversation with the Highway Superintendent would be beneficial.

It was MOVED by Johndrow SECONDED by Milikowsky

To approve the draft letter to Mr. Klyman, and to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:15 PM)

The letter was given to Mr. Klyman.

INTERVIEW – Transfer Station Assistant

Board will conduct an interview with candidate(s) for the position. Votes may be taken.

The board conducted an interview with Mr. Cooper Alexander, applicant for the position of Transfer Station Assistant. Mr. Finn noted that Mr. Alexander had the support of Mr. Jablonski.

After a brief interview, it was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To appoint Mr. Cooper Alexander as transfer station assistant for a term to begin Wednesday, March 4, 2026.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0 (7:18 PM)

INTERVIEW – Municipal Accountant

Board will conduct an interview with candidate(s) for the position. Votes may be taken.

The board conducted an interview with Ms. Hetel Patel, candidate for the position of accountant.

Ms. Patel noted that her full-time position would be Monday through Thursday, and that she could be in Westhampton on Friday. Ms. Patel noted that she could also tend to matters on Monday and Tuesday evenings if necessary.

Ms. Patel noted that the hours of the position would not be fully onsite. The Selectboard agreed that would not be an issue.

Ms. Patel noted that she was familiar with the software that the Town uses, and is comfortable using that

software moving forward.

Ms. Patty Cotton noted her familiarity with the applicant, and that the town would be very lucky to have her.

There was extensive discussion about the process of transition between the town's current accounting services, and a new in-person accountant. Ms. Patel suggested an arrangement of continuing some sort of 'per diem' arrangement with the current accountant after the end of the contracted services

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To offer the municipal accountant position to Ms. Hetel Patel, effective Saturday, March 7, 2026.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:33 PM)

There was some discussion in regard to technical needs of the position. Ms. Patel will coordinate with Ms. Cotton and Mr. Finn on technology needs.

DISCUSSION / DECISION - Proposition 2-1/2 Override Ballot Question

Board will consider a proposal to call for a Proposition 2-1/2 override to support the FY2027 Municipal Budget. Votes may be taken.

Ms. Milikowsky noted that, while services and expenses could be cut by the Selectboard, the purpose in the override ballot question is to allow town residents to have a say in the process.

Ms. Milikowsky also noted that, due to the anticipated impacts of the budget deficit, the board is seeking public opinion on the matter.

Mr. Johndrow agreed noting that it was important for the board to hear from town residents.

Ms. Bronstein noted that three presentations would be held to provide information to the public prior to the election. However, notification of the proposed ballot question must be given to the clerk 35 days prior to the election.

Ms. Cotton: how will the override be worded? Tiered? One single amount?

Ms. Milikowsky: To 'tier' the overrides could result in one department being pitted against another, which would not be desirable. Ms. Milikowsky noted that the deficit was structural, and that continuing on without deep and impactful cuts – or a significant override – was not sustainable.

Ms. Cotton noted that the general public needed to know what was at stake – what cuts could be made – in order to make an informed decision.

There was some further deliberation on the matter.

It was noted that the special election would be on April 11, 2026.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To direct the Town Clerk to plan for a special town election on April 11, 2026, and to place the following ballot question on the warrant: "Shall the Town of Westhampton be allowed to assess an additional \$500,000.00 in real estate and personal property taxes for the purposes of funding the operating budgets of the Public Schools and the Municipal Government for the fiscal year beginning July 1, 2026?"

VOTED 3, 0, 0. (7:51 PM)

There was extensive further discussion and commentary. The Board encouraged all town residents to attend the information sessions and to become informed about the impacts of budget cuts on town services. No further action taken.

MEMBER CONCERNS

Board may discuss new topics raised by individual members, deliberate on potential action or future agenda placement, or give direction to staff.

No concerns were raised.

Adjourn

It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Milikowsky
To Adjourn.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (8:23 PM)

Approved by a vote of the Selectboard at a regular meeting, held on March 9, 2026.



Susan Bronstein

Scott Johndrow

Jennifer Milikowsky